

MacroLens Daily Brief — May 25, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. Europe's STOXX 600 wipes out Iran war losses on peace deal hopes, AI optimism - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 16:29

Europe's STOXX 600 recovered losses from Iran war fears, driven by peace deal hopes and AI optimism.

2. Stocks jump while oil and dollar ease on Iran peace hopes - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-24 23:37

Global stocks rose while oil prices and the U.S. dollar fell on optimism over a potential Iran peace deal.

3. Gold climbs as Middle East peace hopes push oil and dollar lower - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 01:19

Gold prices increased as Middle East peace hopes pushed oil and the dollar lower.

4. Dollar drifts lower as oil falls on Hormuz deal optimism - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 00:27

The U.S. dollar weakened as oil prices fell on optimism regarding a Strait of Hormuz deal.

5. Indian shares jump to two-week high as oil drops on Mideast peace talk hopes - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 02:26

Indian shares hit a two-week high as oil prices dropped on hopes for Middle East peace talks.

6. Iran would open Strait of Hormuz 30 days after peace deal, Nikkei reports citing source - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 18:02

Iran would reopen the Strait of Hormuz 30 days after signing a peace deal, per a Nikkei report.

7. India turns to Latin American, African oil after Hormuz disruption - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 08:13

India shifted to sourcing oil from Latin America and Africa following disruption in the Strait of Hormuz.

8. Explosions heard in Iran, cause unknown, Iranian media reports - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 20:56

Explosions were reported in Iran, with the cause unknown, raising geopolitical uncertainty.

9. Israel will escalate strikes against Hezbollah in Lebanon, Netanyahu says - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 19:39

Israel announced plans to escalate strikes against Hezbollah in Lebanon, heightening regional tensions.

10. Iran says conclusions reached on many topics in potential U.S. memorandum but no deal imminent - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-05-25 07:47

Iran stated conclusions were reached on many topics in a potential U.S. memorandum but no deal is imminent.



Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	745.64	+0.39%	neutral
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	717.54	+0.42%	neutral
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	506.12	+0.60%	bullish
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	285.12	+0.93%	bullish
XLK	Technology ETF	180.39	+1.00%	bullish
XLF	Financials ETF	51.94	+0.41%	neutral
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	82.12	-0.02%	neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	93.88	+0.09%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	84.68	+0.55%	bullish
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	108.37	+0.18%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.91	+0.01%	neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	413.82	-0.76%	● bearish
SLV	Silver ETF	68.36	-1.57%	● bearish
USO	Oil ETF	140.92	-1.14%	● bearish
UNG 	Natural Gas ETF	10.94	-3.44%	● bearish
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	27.77	+0.14%	● neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	107.10	-0.12%	● neutral
FXJ	Japanese Yen ETF	57.70	-0.12%	● neutral
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	76981.12	+0.40%	● neutral
ETH-USD	Ethereum	2097.99	-0.85%	● bearish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-05-25
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.4	2026-05-22
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.43	2026-05-22
VIX	16.76	2026-05-21
USD Index (Broad)	119.2825	2026-05-15

Major Anomalies

UNG — Natural Gas ETF -3.44%

Cause: Natural gas prices fell amid geopolitical tensions in the Middle East, which could disrupt energy supplies but also raise risk of demand destruction.

Forward Impact: Volatility likely persists as market weighs supply risks from Iran-Israel tensions against potential demand slowdown.

 Macro Data Releases — Today

Event	Country	Actual	Forecast	Previous	Surprise
No major macro releases today		None	None	None	— —

 Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

Date	Event	Country	Importance
2026-05-28	Core PCE Price Index MoM	US	high
2026-05-28	GDP Growth Rate QoQ 2nd Est	US	high
2026-05-28	GDP Price Index QoQ 2nd Est	US	medium
2026-05-28	PCE Price Index MoM	US	medium
2026-05-28	PCE Price Index YoY	US	medium
2026-05-28	EIA Crude Oil Stocks Change	US	medium
2026-06-01	ISM Manufacturing Employment	US	medium
2026-06-01	ISM Manufacturing PMI	US	high

Sector Heat Map

Sector Performance Heatmap			
	1D	5D	1M
Technology	+1.0%	+2.3%	+15.8%
Energy	+0.6%	+0.1%	+4.4%
Healthcare	+1.2%	+3.3%	+2.5%
Consumer Staples	+0.2%	+0.2%	+1.6%
Real Estate	+0.1%	+3.1%	+1.4%
Consumer Discretionary	+0.4%	+2.3%	+1.2%
Financials	+0.4%	+1.6%	+0.3%
Industrials	+0.7%	+0.2%	-1.3%
Utilities	+0.8%	+3.4%	-1.6%
Communication Services	-0.6%	-0.5%	-1.6%
Materials	+0.5%	-0.0%	-2.9%

Hot Now

- **Technology** — Strong 1m performance (+15.8%) and positive across all timeframes.
- **Healthcare** — Consistent positive returns with 1d +1.2%, 5d +3.3%, 1m +2.5%.
- **Utilities** — Strong 5d (+3.4%) and 1d (+0.8%) despite negative 1m, suggesting recent reversal.

Cold but Worth Watching

- **Materials** — Negative 1m (-2.9%) and flat 5d, but 1d positive (+0.5%) may indicate stabilization.
- **Communication Services** — Negative across all timeframes, but sector often mean-reverts after prolonged weakness.

- **Industrials** — Negative 1m (-1.3%) but 1d positive (+0.7%), potential for reversal if momentum shifts.

Technology leads with strong momentum, while defensive sectors like Healthcare and Utilities show resilience; cyclical sectors like Materials and Communication Services are underperforming but may offer mean-reversion opportunities.



Daily Conclusion

Despite a lack of macro surprises, the dominant theme is a risk-on rotation into defensive and growth sectors like Technology, Healthcare, and Utilities, fueled by European peace deal hopes and AI optimism.

Generated: 2026-05-25 22:51 UTC | MacroLens v1.0